



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Crossroads Christian Academy
School Website: <https://ccawaycross.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School (ACS) presents clear, repeated indicators of a robust classical Christian identity across purpose, theology, curriculum, and pedagogy. The site explicitly centers “truth, goodness, and beauty,” names the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), highlights Latin, logic, rhetoric, Great Books and the “Great Conversation,” and describes classroom practices such as memorization, recitation, songs, debate/discussion, the Socratic method, imitation, and a senior thesis defense—hallmarks of a mature classical program. Its mission underscores co-laboring with families within a Christ-centered framework. Evidence for a formal, public “portrait of a teacher” or faculty-as-mentors statement is thinner on the website, and explicit parent-formation programming is not highlighted in the crawl material. Nevertheless, ACS’s overall alignment with the Six Essential Elements is strong.

Method note: Scoring and keyword comparisons below follow the positive/negative indicators in Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the supporting lexicon used by this GPT.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
 - “glorify Jesus Christ”; “classical, Christian education”; “wise, virtuous, and humble”; “truth, goodness, and beauty”; “begin and end our search for wisdom in the pages of the Bible, God’s holy, inerrant, and infallible Word”; “the Bible...at the center of the great conversation about the true, the good, and the beautiful”; “under the sovereignty of God through theology.”
- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
 - Positive matches (examples): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral order, classical moral philosophy, formation of the soul; theology, faith and reason, biblical studies, Christian formation; reverence/wonder.
 - Negative matches: none observed (e.g., no “values-neutral,” “moral relativism,” “religiously neutral”).
- Quantitative estimate:
 - Positive hits: 14; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
 - Coverage of subelements (moral realism, theology, liturgy): strong evidence for moral realism and theology; no explicit chapel/liturgy mention in the crawl → percent_coverage ≈ 0.80
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: ACS explicitly grounds education in Christian theology and the transcendentals (true, good, beautiful), and frames learning as pursuit of wisdom under God's sovereignty. Lack of explicit chapel/liturgy language is the only notable gap in this category.

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
- “cultivate wisdom and virtue”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; education “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose.”
- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches: cultivate wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation not information; human flourishing; great conversation.
- Negative matches: none (no “college and career ready”/“21st century skills” emphasis).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage: direct and repeated articulation of all three aims (wisdom/virtue, T□G□B, formation) → percent_coverage ≈ 0.95
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: ACS consistently frames telos as wisdom/virtue and love of the true, good, and beautiful over utilitarian or careerist ends.

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
- “Trivium...Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric”; Latin (grades 5–8); formal logic (grade 8); rhetoric (grade 10); Great Books; “Great Conversation”; senior thesis defense; “interrelation of all knowledge”; Bible central in the curriculum.
- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches: Trivium; Great Books/primary sources; integrated approach/unity of knowledge; wonder and contemplation; rhetoric and dialectic.
- Negative matches: none (no “social studies” framing replacing “history,” no “STEM first”/project dominance language).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage: Trivium, Great Books, integration present; Quadrivium not explicitly described in crawl; history vs. social studies phrasing not seen → percent_coverage ≈ 0.85
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Clear Trivium spine, classical languages, formal logic/rhetoric, Great Books, integration, and thesis make for a strong classical curriculum.

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
- Lower school: “memorization, recitation, and songs”; logic years: “debate and discussion”; explicit “Socratic method in our classrooms”; pedagogy by imitation; seniors present/defend a thesis (upper school rhetoric).
- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches: chanting/singing/memory work; debate/discussion; Socratic seminar/method; imitation/progymnasmata□style rhetoric; capstone orations (thesis).
- Negative matches: none (no “project□based only,” “constructivist/student□directed” emphasis).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 10; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage: strong evidence for chanting/memory, dialectic/Socratic, imitation, rhetoric/thesis; “restful learning/scholé” not explicitly named → percent_coverage ≈ 0.85
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Justification: Methods align tightly with classical pedagogy at each stage of the Trivium; only an explicit scholé/restfulness articulation is missing.

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
- Crawl shows an Employment page (qualifications) but limited public language about teachers as mentors/models, “living curriculum,” or faculty culture.
- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches sought: teachers as models of virtue; mentorship; collegial “faculty of friends”; portrait of a teacher. Site materials in the crawl do not surface these phrases.
- Negative matches: none.
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 1 (weak, generic employment reference); Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage: limited explicit evidence on-site of teacher formation/portrait/mentor language → percent_coverage ≈ 0.35
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Justification: While nothing contradicts classical faculty ideals, the crawl didn’t surface explicit statements (e.g., “teachers as mentors,” “faculty are the living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher”) that many classical schools present publicly.

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- What ACS says (keywords found on site):
- “co□laboring with families” in the mission. No explicit parent□formation programming, book studies, or open□campus language surfaced in the crawl.

- Comparison to positive/negative indicators:
- Positive matches: partnership with parents/coeducators (implicit via “co-laboring with families”).
- Negative matches: none (no consumerist “parent-as-customer” language).
- Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: 2 (partnership language); Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 1.00
- Coverage: partnership present; parent formation and hospitality/open campus not surfaced → percent_coverage ≈ 0.55
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Justification: Clear partnership language, but the site materials reviewed do not highlight parent education/formation practices typical of many classical schools.

Aggregate Judgment

- Category ratings: [R&M Foundations: CLASSICAL] [Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL] [Curriculum: CLASSICAL] [Pedagogy: CLASSICAL] [Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL] [Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Given the very strong evidence in foundations, purpose, curriculum, and pedagogy—and no conflicting language—the overall judgment is CLASSICAL.

Evidence Appendix (selected excerpts with citations)

- Mission and partnership: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ...co-laboring with families...classical, Christian education.”
 - Classical basics: aim is to “cultivate wisdom and virtue”...method is contemplation of the “True, the Good, and the Beautiful.” Trivium and Great Books/Conversation.
 - Trivium stages and methods: memorization, recitation, songs (grammar); debate/discussion (logic); rhetoric culminating in thesis defense. Latin (5–8), formal logic (8), rhetoric (10).
 - Socratic method and content: ACS “employ[s] the Socratic method,” centers Scripture, studies Great Books, includes seniors’ thesis presentations.
 - Lexicon framework used for scoring.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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